

DAROUB

Ras Al Khor Wildlife Sanctuary

A compact field guide

Protected urban wetland at the head of Dubai Creek; quiet bird-hide viewing with strict rules and same-day checks.

Reference edition dated 2026-09-18

A concise Daroub guide based on the listed sources. The location is approximate, not a trailhead. Check current weather and local closures before leaving.

25.194, 55.322 | Asia/Dubai

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01 Place and terrain

Ras Al Khor sits at the head of Dubai Creek within the city. Dubai Municipality and Ramsar describe a protected wetland of sabkha, mudflats and mangroves. The marker is approximate near the Flamingo Hide, not a trailhead or permission to enter the wetland; the image is illustrative coast terrain. Check on the day.

[Dubai Municipality](#) · [Dubai Protected Areas wildlife](#)

[Ramsar Sites Information Service](#) · [Ras Al Khor Wildlife Sanctuary](#)

02 Equipment and preparation

Dubai Municipality suggests binoculars, camera, and a bird and nature guide, and says individuals register on arrival with ID if requested. Practical inference: keep the hide location and Makani details offline, bring personal water, and do not take food or drinks into the quiet hide.

[Dubai Municipality](#) · [Plan Your Visit](#)

[Dubai Municipality](#) · [Book a visit](#)

03 Clothing and footwear

General advice, not a local requirement: use light covering clothes, comfortable shoes for parking areas and short approaches, plus hat or sunglasses for the day's forecast. This is hide viewing, not a mudflat walk, so do not prepare to enter the wetland; keep behaviour quiet inside.

[Dubai Municipality](#) · [Plan Your Visit](#)

[National Center of Meteorology](#) · [Climate Reports](#)

04 Access and transport

The booking page names Mangrove, Flamingo and Lagoon hides, each with separate location details, and notes Mangrove Hide may be temporarily closed. Practical inference: arrange car or taxi access and return for the chosen hide; do not assume a shared walking route or single trailhead.

[Dubai Municipality · Book a visit](#)

05 Season and conditions

Dubai Municipality lists different winter and summer timings and asks visitors to check weather and air quality before planning. Ramsar notes winter importance for migratory waterbirds, but that is not a sighting guarantee. Plan for heat and humidity, and shorten or postpone if conditions are unsuitable on the day.

[Dubai Municipality · Plan Your Visit](#)

[Ramsar Sites Information Service · Ras Al Khor Wildlife Sanctuary](#)

[National Center of Meteorology · Climate Reports](#)

06 Nature and identification limits

Sources record diverse birds and habitats, including waders, raptors, mangroves, fish and invertebrates. The entries below are documented examples or marked as terrain examples only; they are not a full inventory or field key. Watch from the hide, and collect no plant, animal or part.

[Dubai Municipality · Dubai Protected Areas wildlife](#)

[Ramsar Sites Information Service · Ras Al Khor Wildlife Sanctuary](#)

[UAE Government portal · Nature and ecosystems](#)

07 Visit precautions

Main precautions are heat, nearby roads and sanctuary boundaries rather than walking difficulty. Dubai Municipality reminds visitors to keep hydrated and not pass signs or fences. Practical inference: choose a shorter visit in heat, stay with your group, and call 999 police, 998 ambulance or 997 civil defence in emergencies.

[UAE Government portal · Handling emergencies \(police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997\)](#)

[Dubai Municipality · Plan Your Visit](#)

08 Activity choice and booking

For individuals or families, the booking page says visits during opening hours are by walk-in registration; schools, media and research need advance arrangements or a No Objection Certificate. Choose one or more hides according to time, and recheck temporary closures and timings on the day.

[Dubai Municipality · Plan Your Visit](#)

[Dubai Municipality · Book a visit](#)

09 Rules and permits

Rules are local and strict: use the bird hides only, do not pass No Entry signs or fences, and do not approach, feed, harm or collect wildlife or plants. Hides are quiet zones with no phone use, food, drinks, smoking or pets. Drones are not suitable for a casual visit; UAE rules limit them to approved flying zones.

[UAE Government portal · Handling emergencies \(police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997\)](#)

[Dubai Municipality · Plan Your Visit](#)

[UAE Government portal · Aviation safety](#)

Wildlife & plants

Greater flamingo

[Information linked to regional sources](#)

Dubai Municipality and Visit Dubai document flamingos at the sanctuary, and Ramsar records historically large counts. Sightings vary with season and water, so this is broad recognition guidance, not a promise.

Watch quietly from the hide; do not feed it or try to approach the water.

[Dubai Municipality · Dubai Protected Areas wildlife](#)

[Visit Dubai · Ras Al Khor Wildlife Sanctuary](#)

[Ramsar Sites Information Service · Ras Al Khor Wildlife Sanctuary](#)

Waders

Information linked to regional sources

Dubai Municipality and Ramsar list waders and shorebirds on the mudflats. Small species can look similar, so this entry is not a precise field-identification key.

Keep a long distance and do not leave the visitor area to follow a small bird.

[Dubai Municipality](#) · [Dubai Protected Areas wildlife](#)

[Ramsar Sites Information Service](#) · [Ras Al Khor Wildlife Sanctuary](#)

Herons and egrets

Information linked to regional sources

Visit Dubai notes herons and egrets among sanctuary wildlife. Size and colour separation needs a field guide or ranger; do not assume they will be near a hide on every visit.

Do not use flash or calls to attract them; quiet is part of hide use.

[Dubai Municipality](#) · [Plan Your Visit](#)

[Visit Dubai](#) · [Ras Al Khor Wildlife Sanctuary](#)

Raptors

Information linked to regional sources

Dubai Municipality mentions raptors, and Ramsar records greater spotted eagle among documented species. Birds may pass high or far away; binoculars are better than approaching.

Do not chase a bird between car parks or near the road; keep attention on traffic and boundaries.

[Dubai Municipality](#) · [Dubai Protected Areas wildlife](#)

[Ramsar Sites Information Service](#) · [Ras Al Khor Wildlife Sanctuary](#)

Mangroves

Information linked to regional sources

Dubai Municipality and Ramsar document mangroves as a key sanctuary habitat. This is broad plant-habitat guidance, not scientific species identification; roots are sensitive habitat.

Stay in the visitor area and do not collect leaves, roots or mud material.

[Dubai Municipality](#) · [Dubai Protected Areas wildlife](#)

[Ramsar Sites Information Service](#) · [Ras Al Khor Wildlife Sanctuary](#)

Mudflat crabs and small fish

Terrain example; not proof of presence at given coordinates

General coastal example: sources document fish, invertebrates and mudflat habitat, but not a particular crab species here. Do not use this entry to identify food or collect animals.

Do not enter mud or handle animals; observe only from the available distance.

[Dubai Municipality](#) · [Dubai Protected Areas wildlife](#)

[Ramsar Sites Information Service](#) · [Ras Al Khor Wildlife Sanctuary](#)

[UAE Government portal](#) · [Nature and ecosystems](#)

Travel companions

A buddy-planning recommendation, not a safety guarantee. Remote or technical routes need group planning with a local expert. Avoid going alone.

Before you leave

Choose your route and turn-back point; check entry permissions and closures.

Check the forecast and save an offline map.

Review clothing, water, food and communication with your companions.

Agree a return time and alternative plan, and share them with a trusted contact.

Educational terrain examples, not a complete inventory or verified species list for these coordinates. Do not eat plants or animals based on this guide.

Sources and further reading

1. UAE Government portal · Handling emergencies (police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997)
<https://u.ae/en/information-and-services/justice-safety-and-the-law/Safety/handling-emergencies>
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2. Dubai Municipality · Dubai Protected Areas wildlife
<https://www.dm.gov.ae/dubai-protected-areas/wildlife/>
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3. Dubai Municipality · Plan Your Visit
<https://www.dm.gov.ae/dubai-protected-areas/plan-your-visit/>
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4. Dubai Municipality · Book a visit
<https://www.dm.gov.ae/dubai-protected-areas/book-a-visit/>
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5. Visit Dubai · Ras Al Khor Wildlife Sanctuary
<https://www.visitdubai.com/en/places-to-visit/ras-al-khor-wildlife-sanctuary>
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6. Ramsar Sites Information Service · Ras Al Khor Wildlife Sanctuary
<https://rsis Ramsar.org/ris/1715>
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7. National Center of Meteorology · Climate Reports
<https://www.ncm.gov.ae/pages/climate-reports?lang=en>
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8. UAE Government portal · Aviation safety
<https://u.ae/en/information-and-services/justice-safety-and-the-law/Safety/aviation-safety>
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9. UAE Government portal · Nature and ecosystems
<https://u.ae/en/information-and-services/environment-and-energy/Nature-and-wildlife/topography-and-ecosystems>
2026-09-18

Further guide from the official publisher

Dubai Protected Areas - Plan your visit

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